

Yes, `useLocale` (from `next-intl`) and the `NEXT_LOCALE` cookie generally store the same value, but they serve different purposes. `useLocale` provides the current, active locale for immediate UI rendering, while `NEXT_LOCALE` is a cookie used to persist that preference, allowing Next.js to remember the language on future visits. [GitHub +3](#)

- **Synchronization:** While they often align, the cookie might not update instantly if the locale is changed via URL navigation, potentially leaving the cookie holding an older value until the next update.
- **Purpose:** `useLocale()` is for runtime usage within components, while `NEXT_LOCALE` allows middleware to detect the user's preferred language before the page loads.
- **Priority:** In many setups, the URL locale takes precedence over the `NEXT_LOCALE` cookie. [Phrase +3](#)